

Phillip Clapham

Enterprise WordPress Engineer & Web Infrastructure Architect

PHP · JavaScript · Performance · Security · Accessibility · AI-First Development Workflow

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Available now for contract, fractional, and project engagements. Remote, US-based.

SUMMARY

Twenty years building, hosting, securing, and rescuing production WordPress and web properties, from single-owner sites to Fortune 500 enterprise architecture, most recently as the sole Senior Solutions Architect for Pressable's (Automattic) highest-value enterprise portfolio. Custom themes and plugins from the ground up, PHP and modern JavaScript, the block editor, hooks, and the REST API, plus the infrastructure underneath: performance, caching, migration, security, uptime.

AI-FIRST DEVELOPMENT PRACTICE

- Author of *A Structural Theory of Harnesses* (April 2026), the first theoretical account of harness engineering as a named discipline. DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19570642 Claude Code has been daily production infrastructure since September 2025.
- Multi-model adversarial code review: every significant change is reviewed by independent model lineages, because a reviewer sharing the author's training distribution shares its blind spots. Layered with deterministic checks, grounding against source, and human sign-off — systems built to be governed, not trusted.
- Supporting tooling shipped open source: [anneal-memory](#) and [Levain](#), both on PyPI. The result is AI-assisted delivery speed without the unreviewed-code debt that usually comes with it.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Solutions Consultant — Columbus, OH (Remote)

November 2011 – October 2024 · Resumed July 2026, accepting engagements

- Solo advisory and delivery for organizations with no supporting firm behind them — OCCRRA, Marana Healthcare, nonprofits, government-adjacent clients. Full-lifecycle ownership as the only technical resource: custom theme and plugin development, solution design, hosting, migration, security, accessibility, training.
- Client relationships sustained for years, several past a decade — the only real measure of whether the work held up. Translated technical decisions for non-technical stakeholders and boards, then executed them.

Pressable (Automattic) — Senior Solutions Architect / Technical Account Manager

October 2024 – July 2026 · Remote

Sole technical account manager for Pressable's highest-value enterprise WordPress portfolio. Authored tooling that shipped as how the whole organization operated.

- WordPress.com and WordPress VIP to managed-host migration tooling, including automated Gutenberg block replacement. Thousands of migrations through the WP Engine / Automattic disruption; trained support teams on the playbook.

- Authored the org's load-testing and capacity-planning tool, its primary instrument for infrastructure sizing and performance validation. Released publicly as **MicroChaos CLI** (PHP, WP-CLI) — load testing from inside WordPress for managed environments where external tools are blocked, simulating authenticated users, WooCommerce flows, REST endpoints, and warm or cold cache.
- WooCommerce performance engineering that cut full seconds off checkout flows and preserved multi-six-figure accounts that were actively churning.
- Performance-audit workshop pattern — backend profiling, architecture review, tailored remediation. Adopted org-wide; enterprise customers called it more valuable than paid consulting engagements.
- 100+ competitive technical evaluations and enterprise pilots — frontend comparison, backend architecture analysis, empirical capacity math — roughly 45 through a harness I automated.
- Partnered with Fortune 500 technical leadership through C-suite on infrastructure strategy, translating architecture tradeoffs into revenue, risk, and cost terms. Delivered a live full-stack WordPress performance walkthrough for The WP Minute (May 2026).

Forefront Web — Lead Support Developer · Dublin, OH (Remote)

July 2020 – October 2024

Led development and support across 300+ web properties, and rebuilt customer engagement from reactive ticket-handling into structured technical enablement.

- Cut average resolution time from 2–3 weeks to under 2 days by redesigning workflows and adding proactive outreach.
- Built technical training for junior developers and authored *Digital Security for Website Owners* for the client base; the security enablement program tripled return business from high-trust enterprise clients.

InflatableOffice — Web Developer · Akron, OH (Remote)

February 2018 – May 2020

Custom ecommerce platforms; infrastructure for 300+ client sites across 10+ servers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

WORDPRESS

Custom theme and plugin development from scratch, hooks and filters, PHP APIs, block editor and Gutenberg, REST API, WP-CLI, multisite, WooCommerce, ACF, Elementor, WordPress VIP and VIP migrations, migration at scale, performance profiling with Query Monitor and New Relic, security hardening, managed-host and self-hosted.

CORE WEB DEVELOPMENT

PHP, modern JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, responsive development, accessibility and WCAG-minded implementation, secure coding, code review. Also Python, SQL, MySQL / MariaDB, Go, Swift, Laravel.

HOSTING, INFRASTRUCTURE & DEVOPS

Linux, nginx and Apache, cPanel / WHM, Redis and Memcached object caching, Varnish, Cloudflare and CDN, DNS, SSL/TLS, load testing and capacity planning, incident response, uptime monitoring. AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, CloudFront, Route 53), Docker, CI/CD, infrastructure as code, Git, staging and deploy.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Musicians Institute, Hollywood CA · Udacity Mobile Web Specialist · freeCodeCamp Full Stack · Google Analytics Certified